



5 Flip the cloth over. Fold in a long side twice, including the pocket flaps, to make a 3cm (1¼in) seam. Weight the seam down to hold it as you rivet it in place. Repeat with the other long side. Flip the cloth back over and you have made your saddle bag planters. Repeat to make as many as you need.



6 For extra ornamentation, you can cut out some motifs from attractive reusable shopping bags to add to the saddle bags. Glue the designs on to the saddle bags with a waterproof PVA glue or superglue and then leave to dry.



7 Take a length of hanging-basket liner and line each of the planting pockets, cutting the liner to size with scissors. It should sit just below the lip of the pocket. This will help keep the compost moist in the pockets. To conserve moisture further, add 5g (¼oz) of water-retaining gel to every 5 litres (1 gallon) of multi-purpose compost.



8 Hang the bags in their final positions. Remove plants from their pots, tease out any circling roots, then position them in the pockets. Fill around with compost, and firm in. Water thoroughly.

CARE ADVICE

WATERING

Containers above ground level are more exposed and plants tend to dry out more easily, so water often in the growing season, especially if hot and sunny, and while plants are establishing.

FEEDING

Add diluted liquid feed to the water once or twice a month in the main growing season. You can also mist plants in hot weather, but

not when in direct hot sunlight as the leaves might scorch.

GENERAL CARE

Remove any damaged, diseased, or dying foliage throughout the growing period. Some plants are not frost hardy and will die back if left outside in winter. Reduce watering in winter to minimal. Top up or change the compost in spring.

